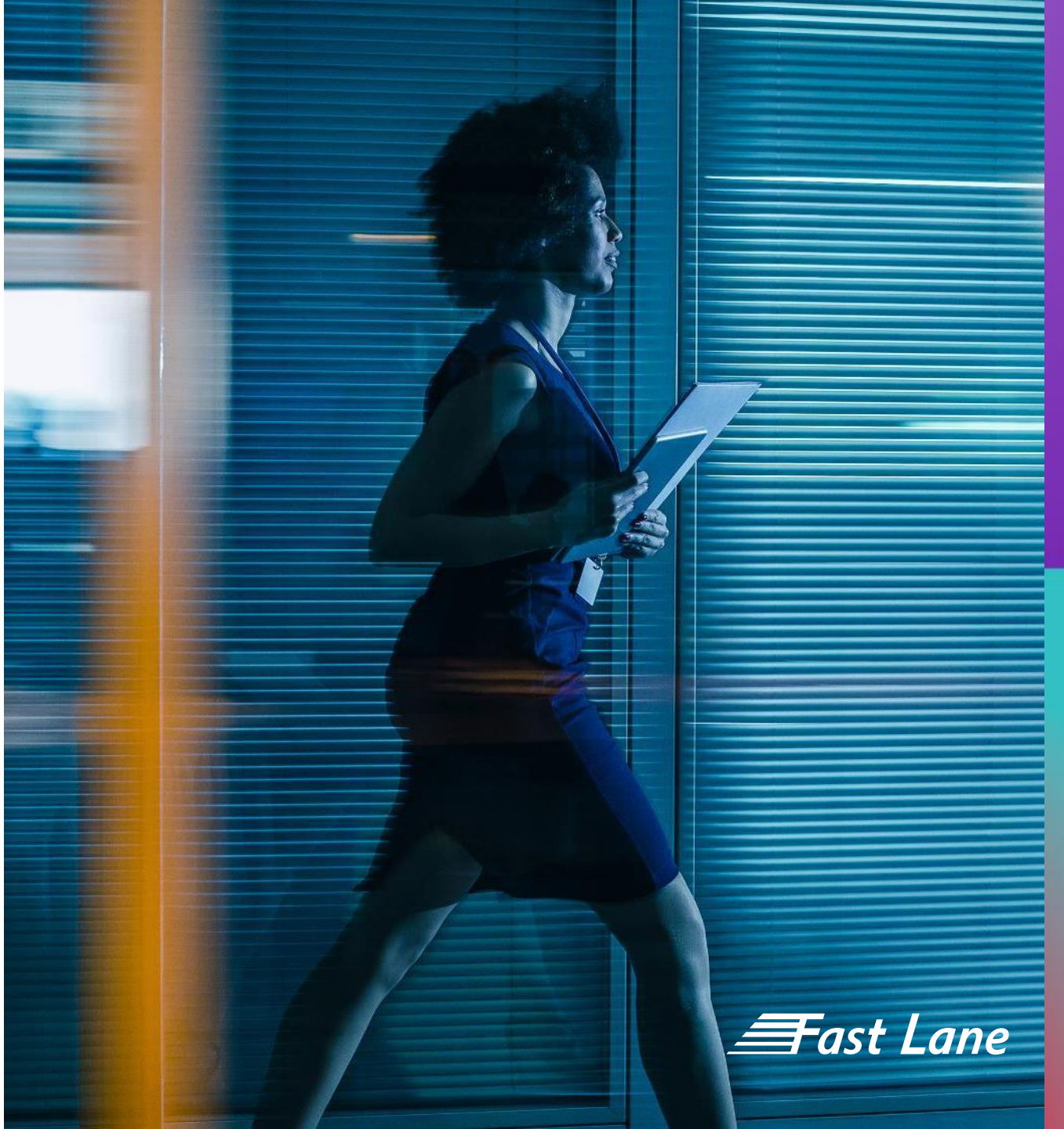
# Fast Lane Group

## Worldwide Education & Professional Services

Microsoft Solutions Partner

Microsoft Cloud Training Services




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— AGENTIC AI: FROM STRATEGY TO **PRODUCTION.**

# Alexander Kastil

Full stack, from enterprise software to agentic AI. Since 1996

### AI at Work
Value discovery, KPI mapping and roadmap

### Enterprise AI
Governed multi-agent systems on Microsoft Copilot and Foundry

### Agentic Software Engineering
Harness architecture for Claude Code and GitHub Copilot

### Team Enablement
AI driven content production and delivery

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INTEGRATIONS

AGENTIC AI CONSULTING · VIENNA



Microsoft CERTIFIED — AGENTIC AI BUSINESS SOLUTIONS ARCHITECT — ★★★

Microsoft CERTIFIED — AZURE AI APP AND AGENT DEVELOPER — ASSOCIATE ★★

Microsoft CERTIFIED — DEVOPS ENGINEER — EXPERT ★★★

SCAN TO CONNECT
**integrations.at**

MODULE 1

# Introduction to Copilot Cowork & Copilot Studio

The foundation for the whole course

Automate Business Processes with Copilot Studio and Copilot Cowork



01

## Agents & Copilots for Microsoft 365

The vocabulary, the ecosystem map and the step to an agent

02

## How Agents Work

The agentic loop, the three parts of every agent and the design patterns

03

## Agent Harnesses: Choose the Runtime

The four harnesses of Copilot Studio and how to choose one

04

## Where to Build and What It Costs

The build paths and how Copilot Credits pay for them

05

## Copilot Chat & Productivity Agents

Researcher, Analyst, SharePoint agents and Agent Builder

06

## Prepare the Tenant: Licenses & Credits

Optional: the licenses, credit sources and costs behind each module

# Introduction to Copilot Cowork and Copilot Studio

## The foundation for the whole course

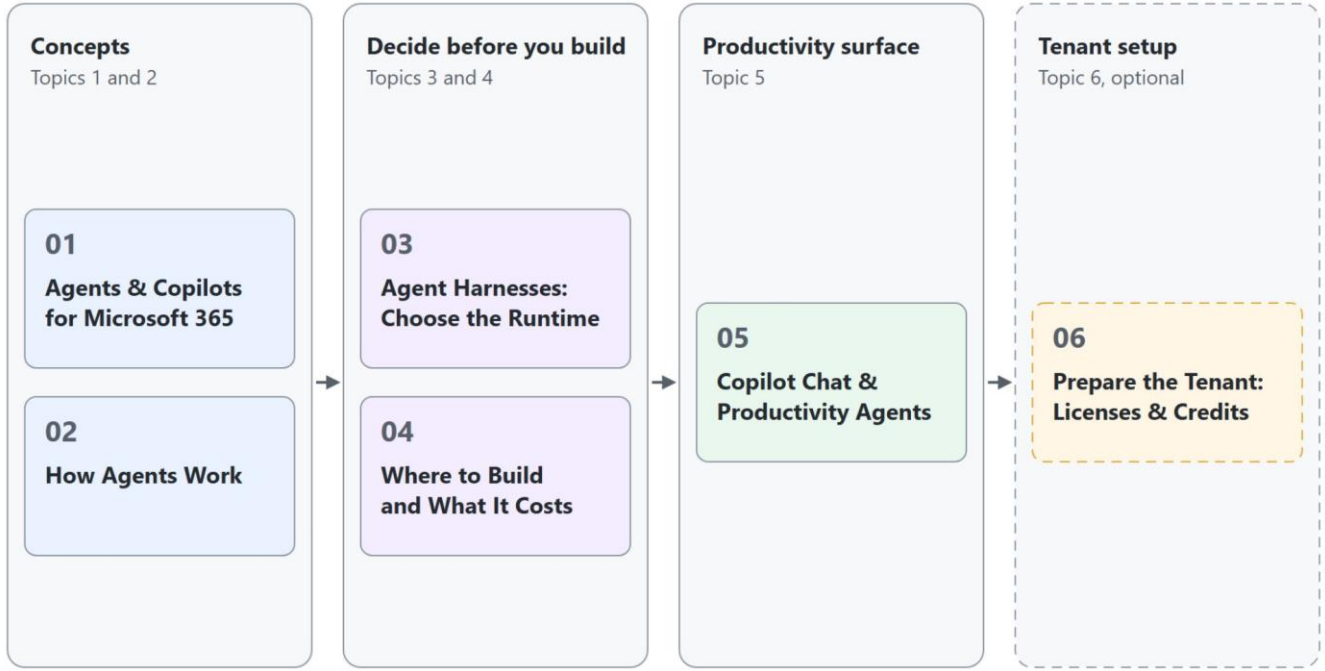
- **Concepts**: what copilots and agents are, and how every agent works
- **Decide before you build**: the agent harness, the build paths and what Copilot Credits cost
- **Productivity surface**: Copilot Chat, Researcher, Analyst and SharePoint agents



# Overview

## The path through the six topics

- The vocabulary and **how agents work**: the loop, the agent, the model and the harness
- **Agent harnesses**: the four runtimes in Copilot Studio and how to choose one
- **Where to build**, and how Copilot Credits pay for it
- **Copilot Chat** and the productivity agents that come ready to use
- Optional: **prepare the tenant** with the licenses and credits each module needs



01

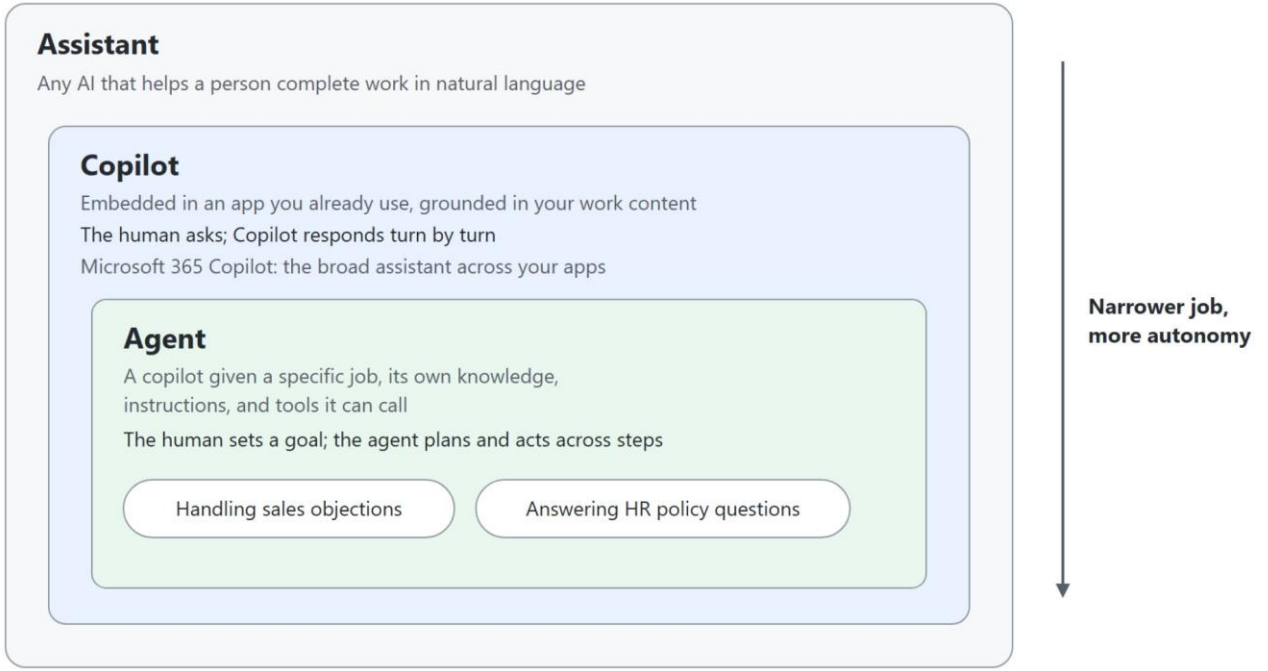
# Agents & Copilots for Microsoft 365

The vocabulary, the ecosystem map and the step to an agent

# Copilot, agent and assistant

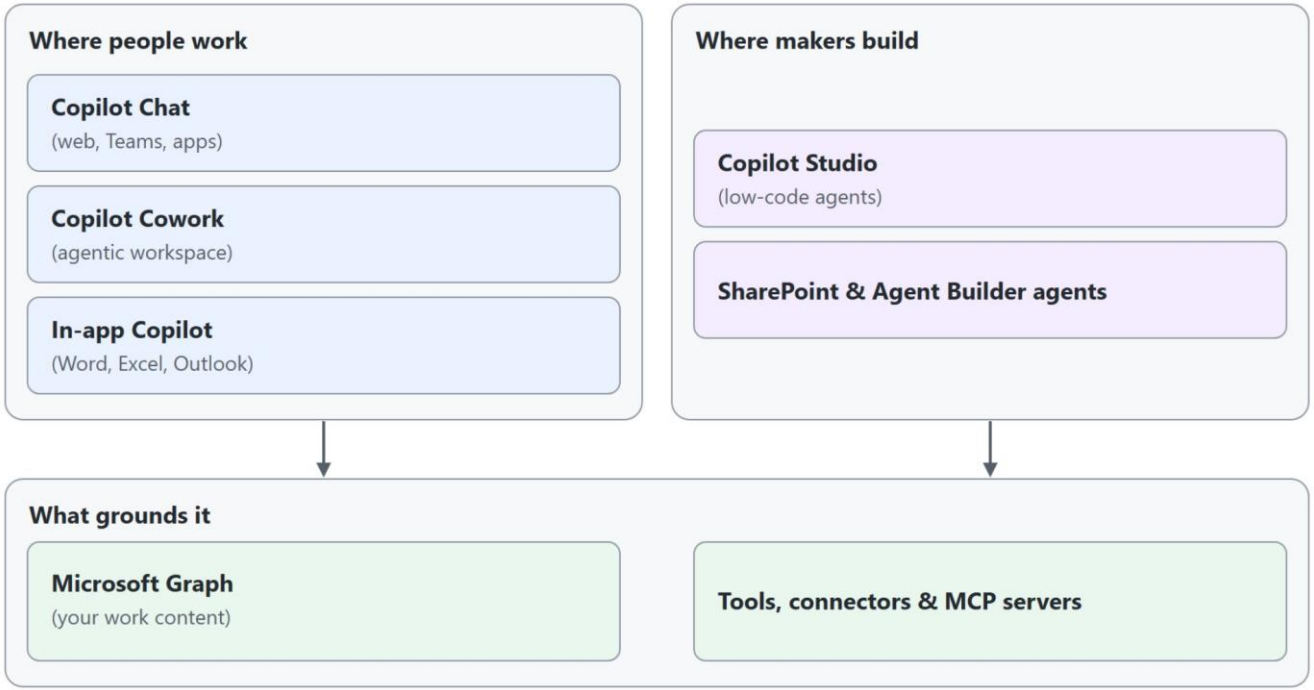
## Three terms the course uses with fixed meanings

- **Assistant**: any AI that helps a person complete work in natural language
- **Copilot**: embedded in an app you already use, grounded in your work content
- **Agent**: a copilot with a specific job, its own knowledge, instructions and tools
- With a copilot the human asks; with an agent the human **sets a goal**



# The Microsoft 365 Copilot ecosystem

## Experiences, build surfaces and the foundation that grounds them

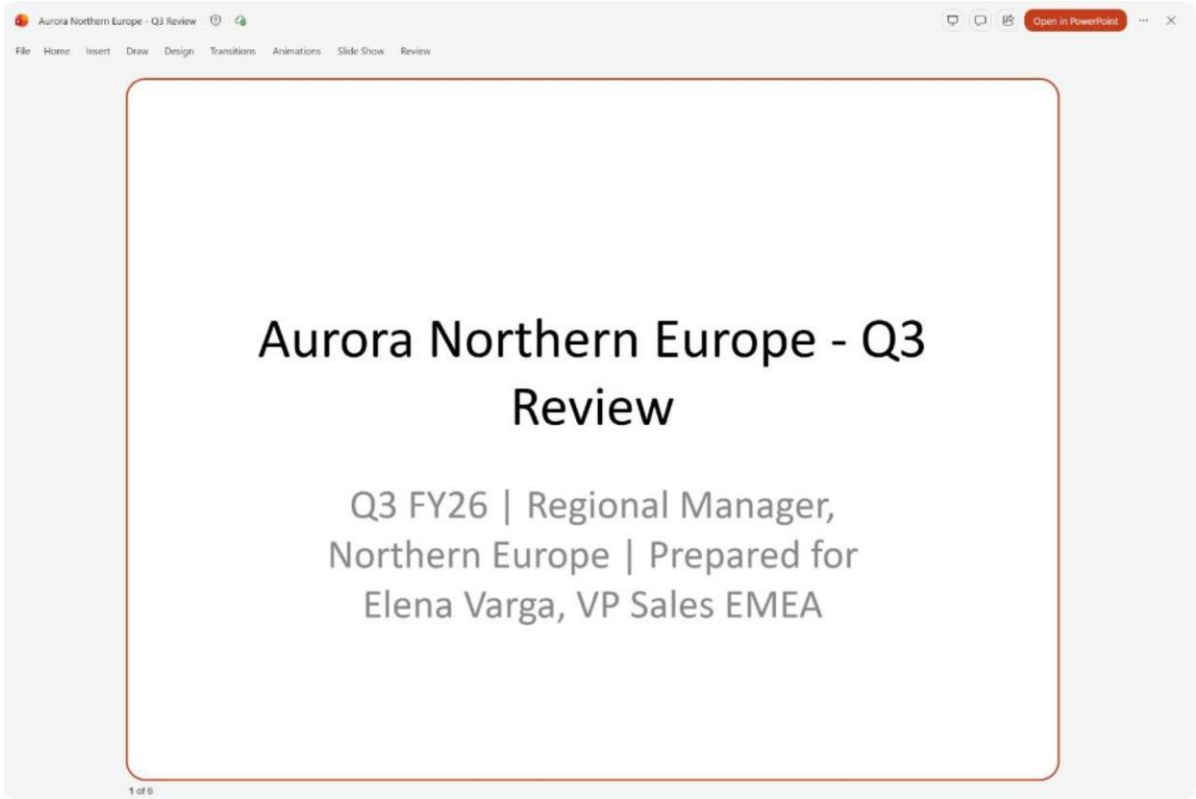



- What people use and what makers build both stand on **Microsoft Graph** and the tools that reach other systems

# From copilot to agent

## Cowork turns an outcome into a finished deck

- Copilot Chat answers **one question at a time** while you do the planning
- Cowork takes the **outcome** you describe and proposes the plan
- It works the steps itself, here a six-slide Q3 review built from three files
- The finished deck comes back **for your review**, with a list of what to check before you present



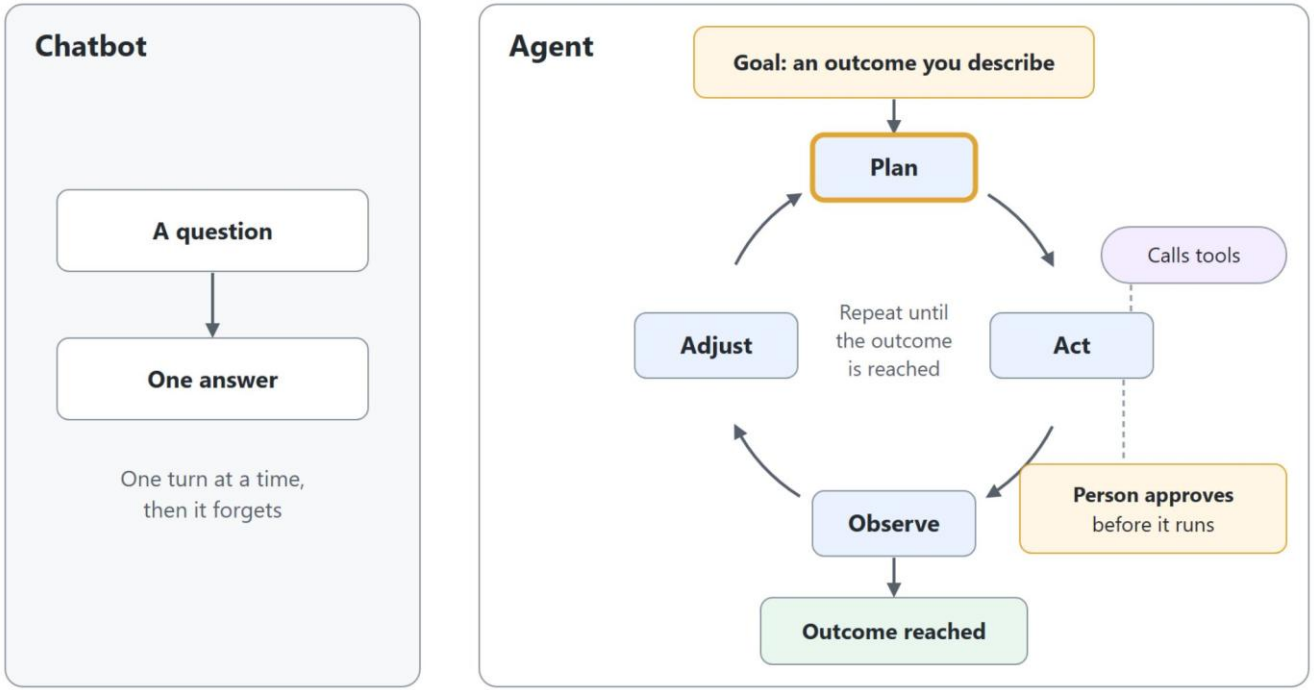
02

# How Agents Work

The agentic loop, the three parts of every agent and the design patterns

# What makes an AI agentic

## From answering a question to working toward a goal

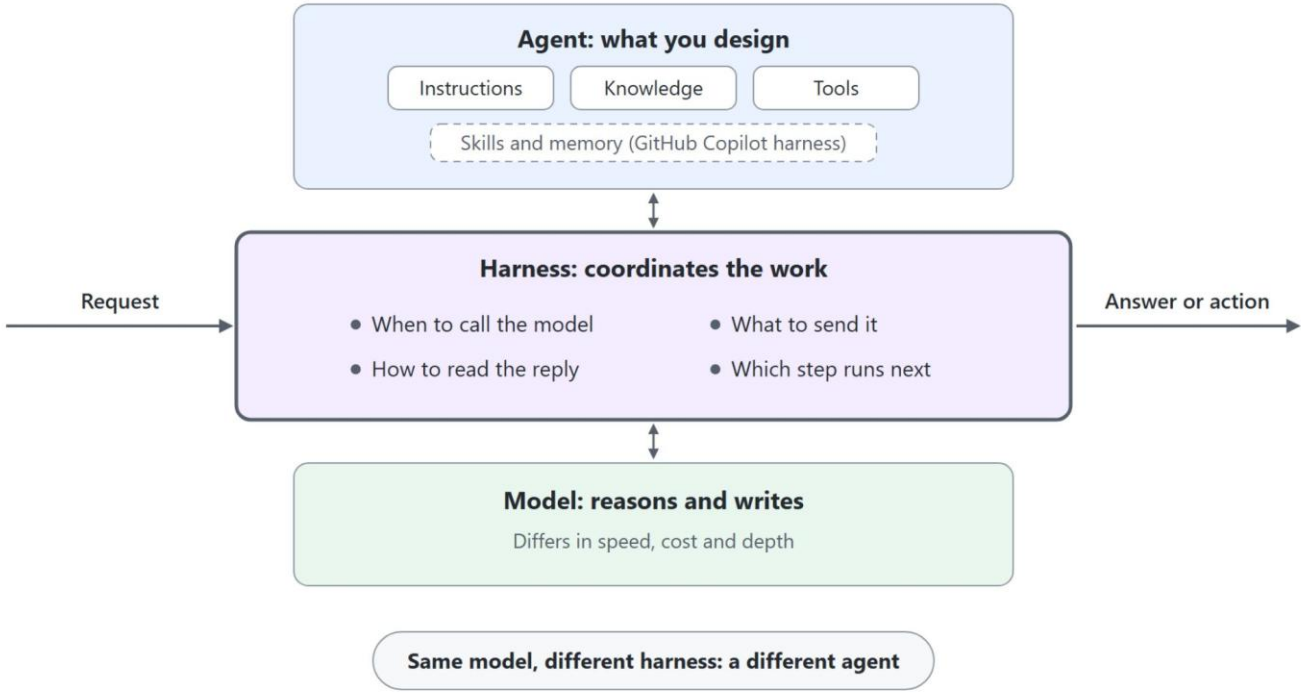



- A chatbot answers once, while an **agent** plans, acts, observes and adjusts until the goal is reached, and a person approves before an action runs

# Agent, model and harness

## What you design, what reasons, what coordinates

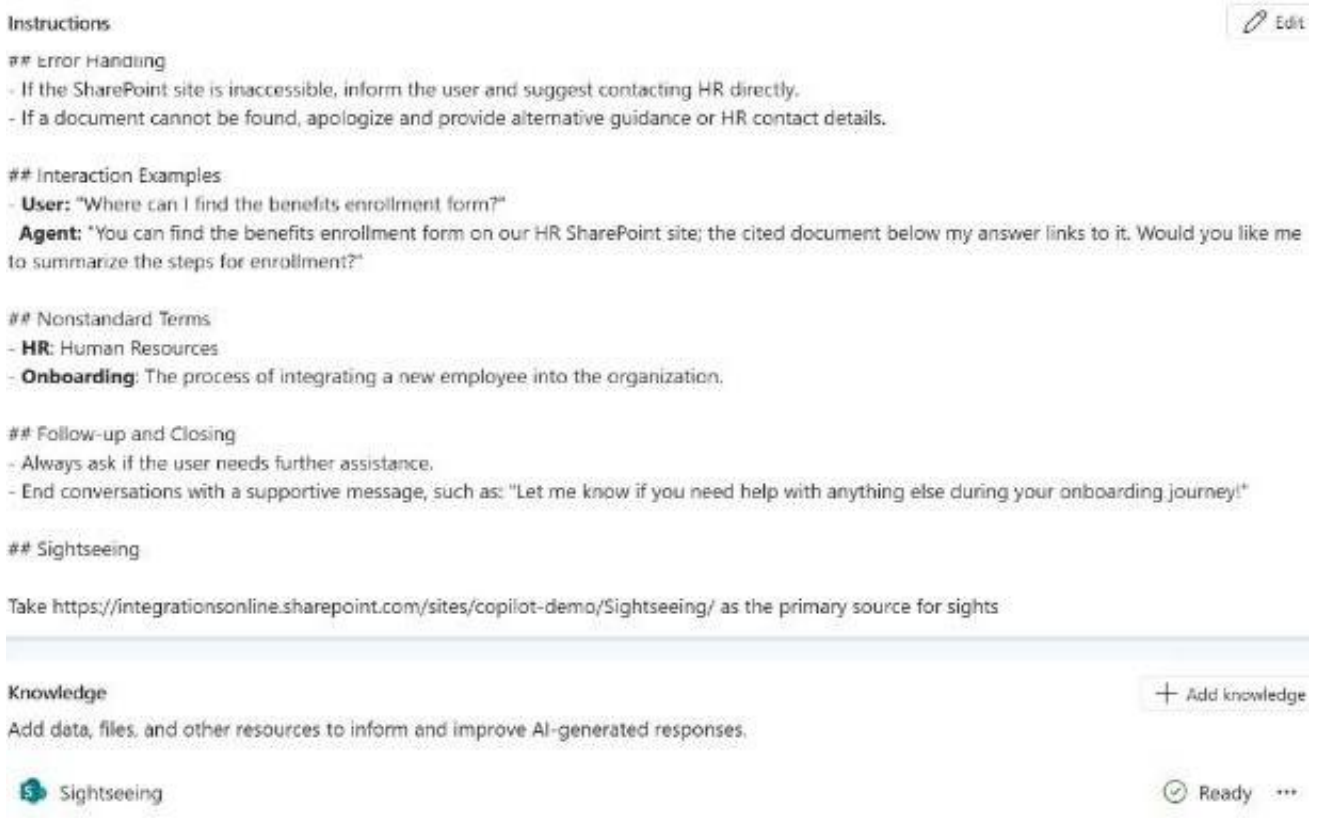
- The **agent** is what you design: instructions, knowledge, tools and boundaries
- The **model** reasons and writes, and models differ in speed, cost and depth
- The **harness** coordinates: when to call the model, what to send, which step runs next
- Same model, different harness: **a different agent**



# What you design in every agent

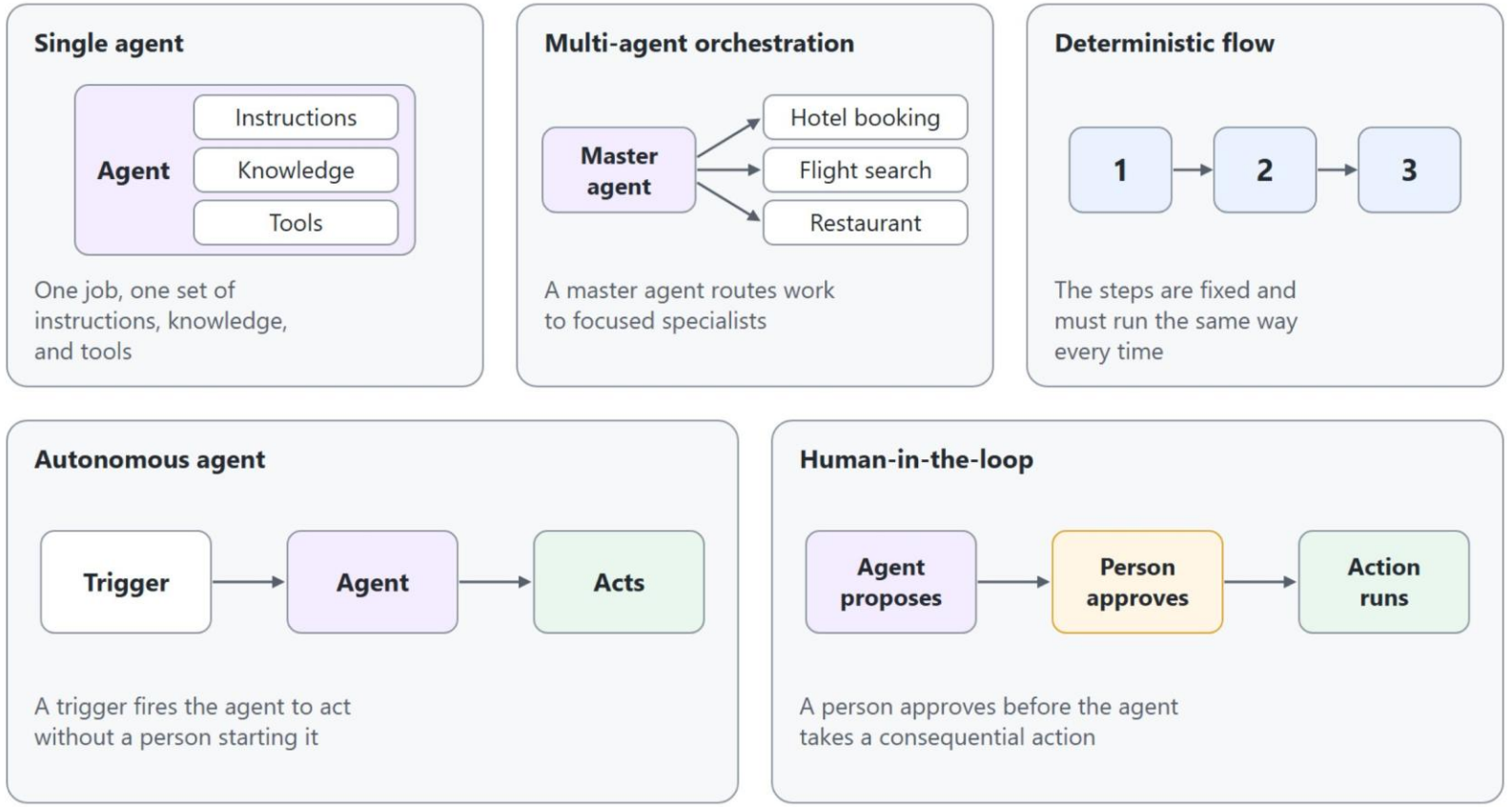
## Instructions, knowledge and tools in a Copilot Studio agent

- **Instructions** set the role, tone and scope, here the onboarding agent's rules and examples
- **Knowledge** grounds answers in your content through RAG, here a SharePoint site
- **Tools** act on live systems, often through an MCP server; this agent has none yet
- A weak agent is thin in one part: **name which one** to fix it



# Design patterns in agentic AI

## Five patterns to choose and combine




- Choose a **pattern** for the shape of the problem, and combine several in one solution

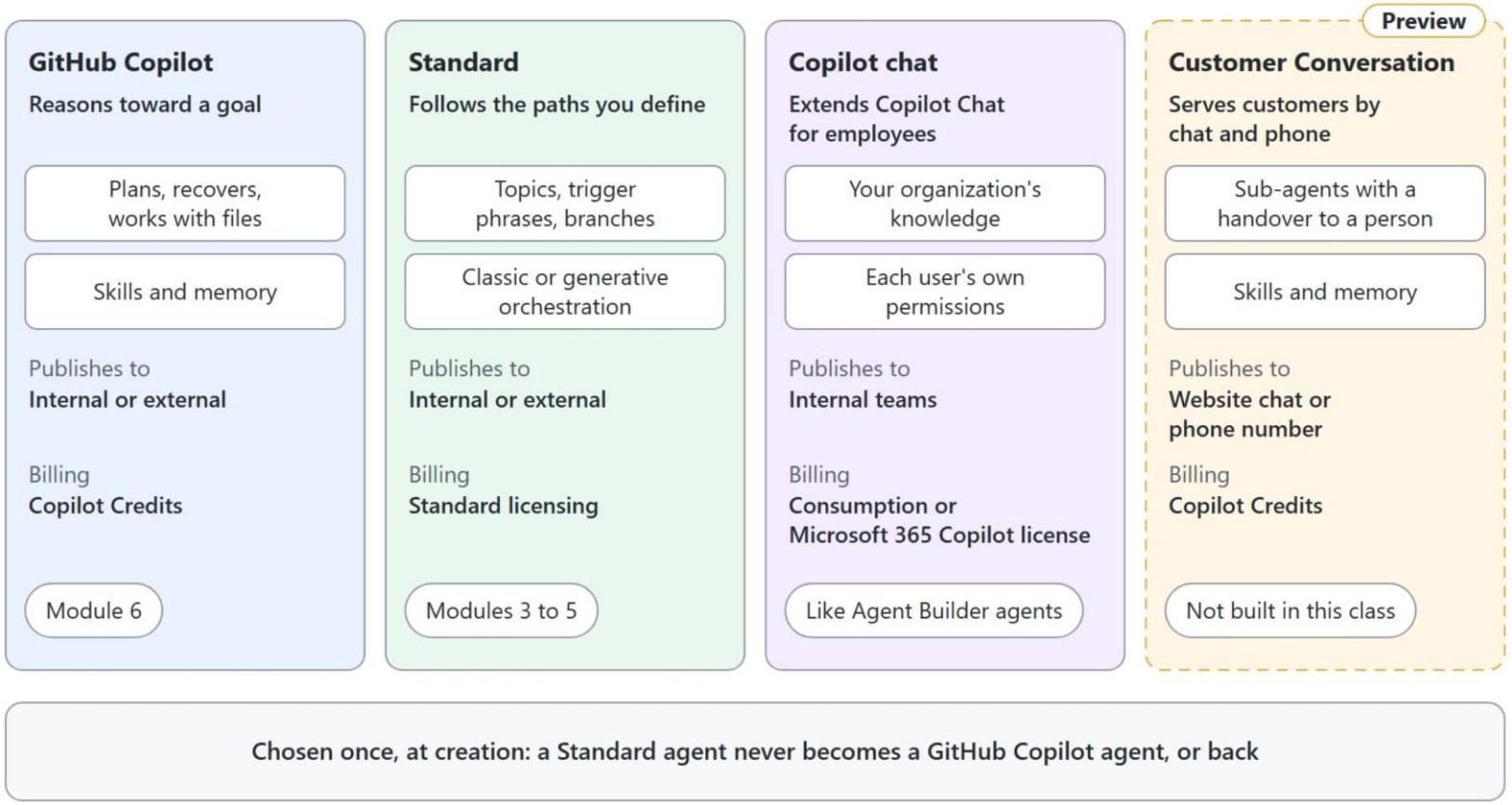
# 03

# Agent Harnesses: Choose the Runtime

The four harnesses of Copilot Studio and how to choose one

# Four harnesses in Copilot Studio

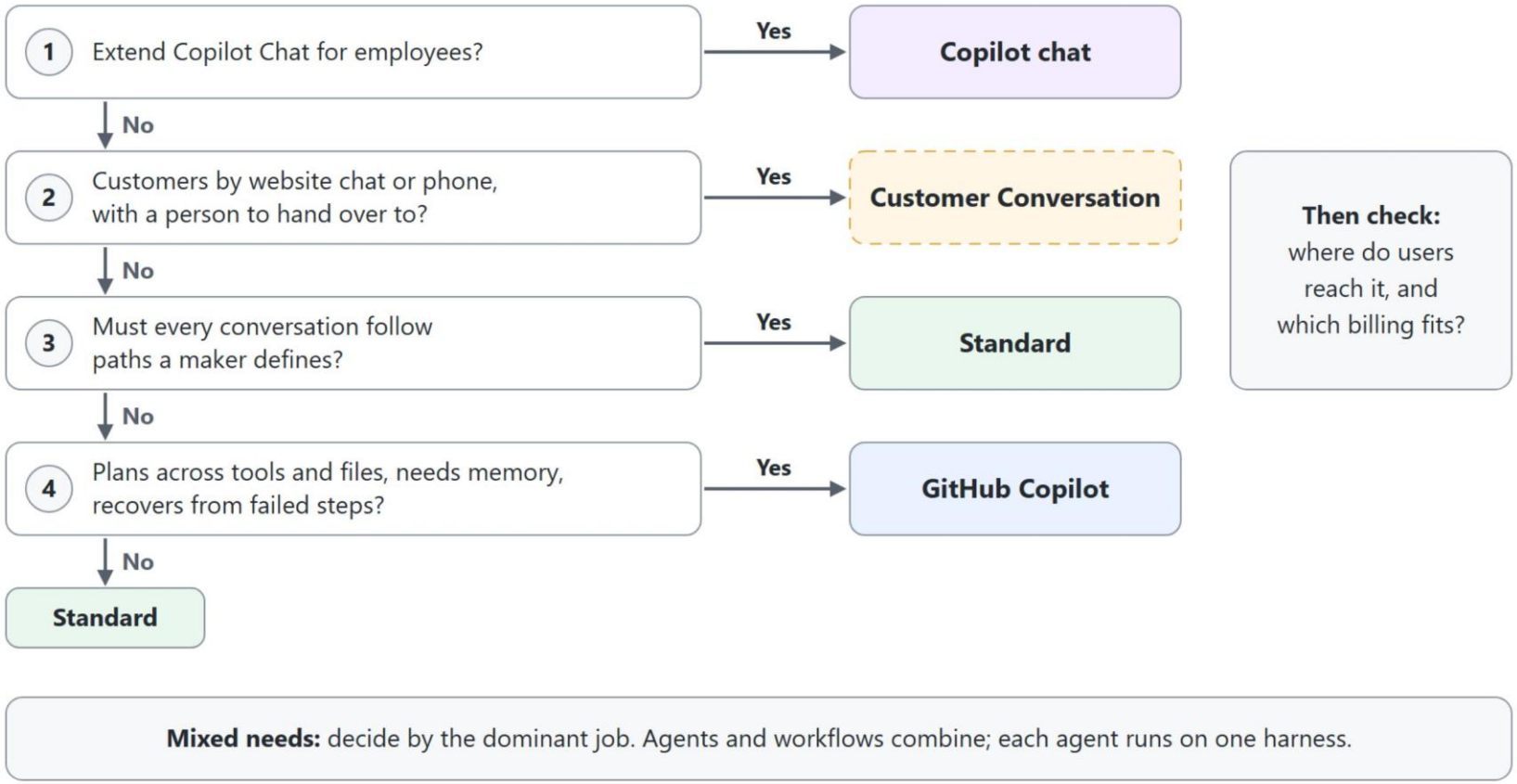
## The runtime you pick decides behavior, features and billing




- The harness is chosen **once, at creation**, and fixes behavior, features, publishing and billing

# Choose the harness

## Answer before you create the agent

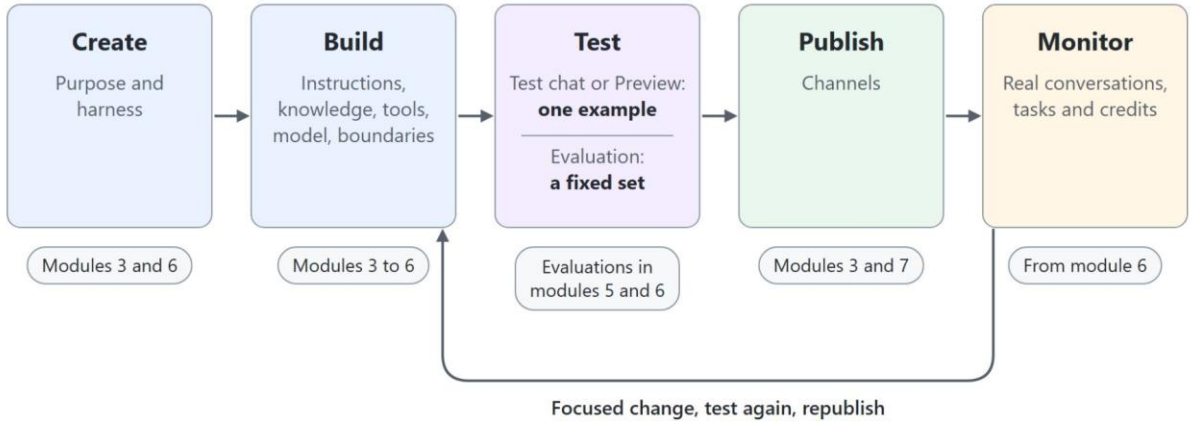



- Walk the questions **top to bottom**; the first Yes names the harness, then check reach and billing

# One lifecycle on every harness

## Create, build, test, publish, monitor, then improve

- Every agent is **created, built, tested, published and monitored**, whatever harness runs it
- A test chat shows **one example**; an evaluation runs **a fixed set** you can compare
- Monitor shows **real use**, and each finding becomes one focused change
- The tab names differ by harness; **the stages don't**



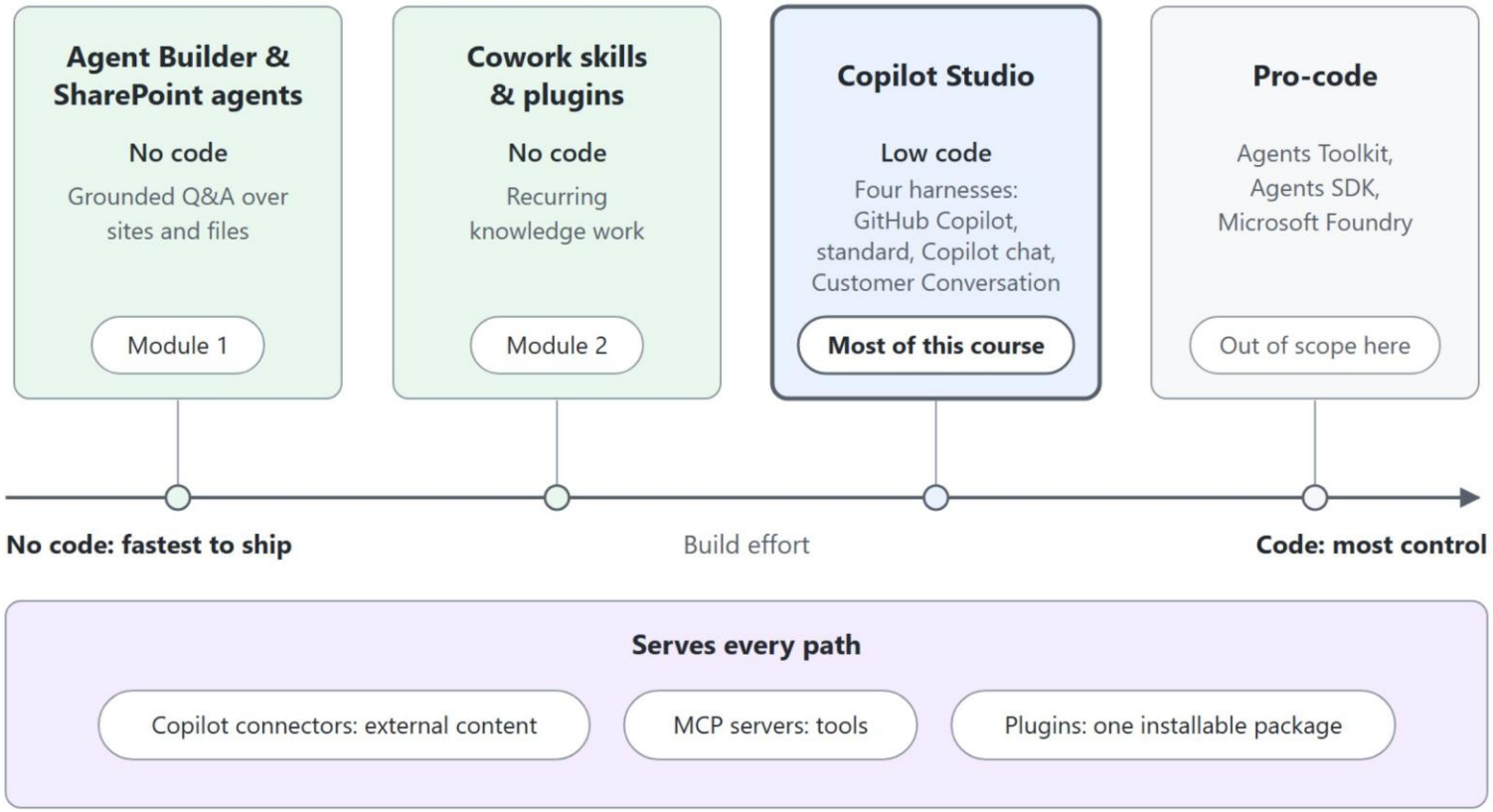
04

# Where to Build and What It Costs

The build paths and how Copilot Credits pay for them

# Where to build an agent

## The lowest-effort path that meets the need

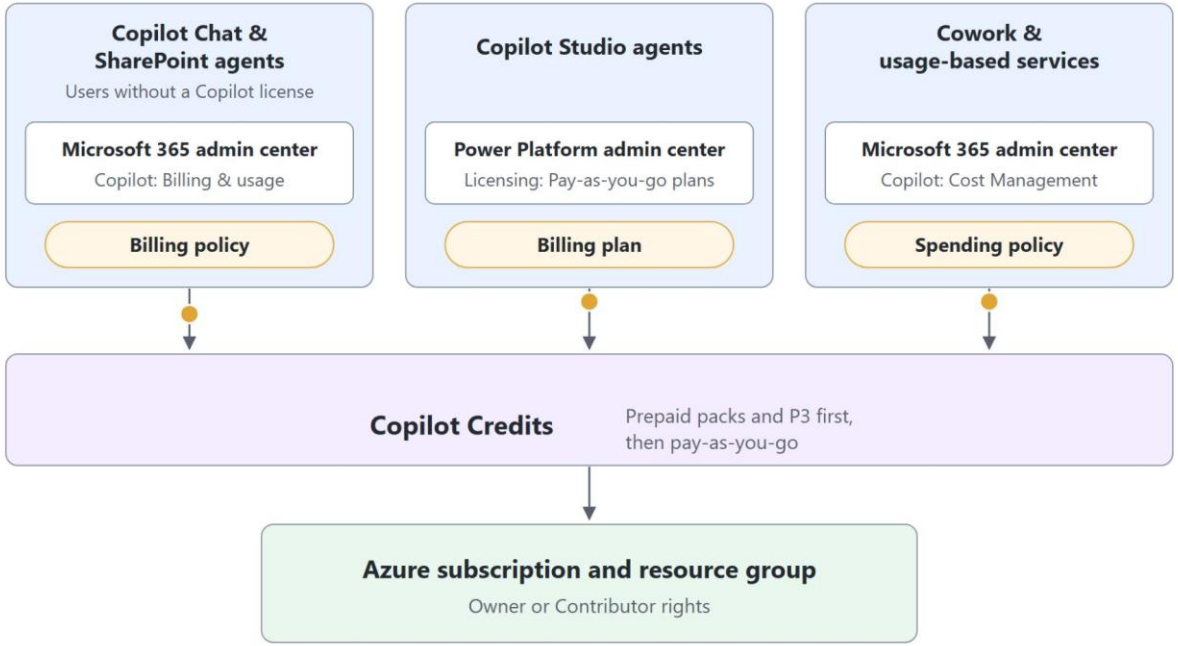



- Start on the **lowest-effort path** that meets the need, and move up when a tool call, a channel or a multi-step process requires it

# What agents cost

## Copilot Credits and the three billing routes

- **Copilot Credits**: one currency for agent usage since September 2025
- A **Copilot license** zero-rates Copilot Studio agents in Chat, Teams and SharePoint
- **Three routes**: billing policy, billing plan, spending policy
- **Prepaid first**, then pay-as-you-go to one Azure subscription



# Spending limits

## Guardrails set when you activate Copilot Credits

- **Monthly spending limit**: the tenant's total ceiling for the billing period
- **Per-user limit**: the most any one user can consume, at least 2,000 credits a month
- **Alert thresholds** below the ceiling notify you before it is reached
- Set them **at activation**, with numbers from the Copilot Credit Estimator



05

# Copilot Chat & Productivity Agents

Researcher, Analyst, SharePoint agents and Agent Builder

# Productivity and SharePoint agents

## Ready-to-use agents with nothing to build

- **Researcher**: multi-step research across work content and the web, returned as a source-cited report
- **Analyst**: reasons over your data to produce analysis, tables and charts
- **SharePoint agent**: scoped to a whole site, specific folders or selected documents
- It answers only from what the **person asking** already has permission to see
- Created with **no code**, published to SharePoint and Microsoft 365 Copilot
- **Copilot in OneDrive and SharePoint** works on the files: trends across spreadsheets, folder sorting, interactive HTML reports



# Agent Builder

## Your own agent in Microsoft 365 Copilot, with no code

- **Describe** the job in plain language, or configure each field by hand or from a template, then test on **Try it**
- **Knowledge**: SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams chats, your email, public sites, uploaded files and Copilot connectors
- **Share** it with people, or submit it to the org catalog for the Agent Store
- **No actions**: copy the agent to Copilot Studio when it needs connectors or workflows



06

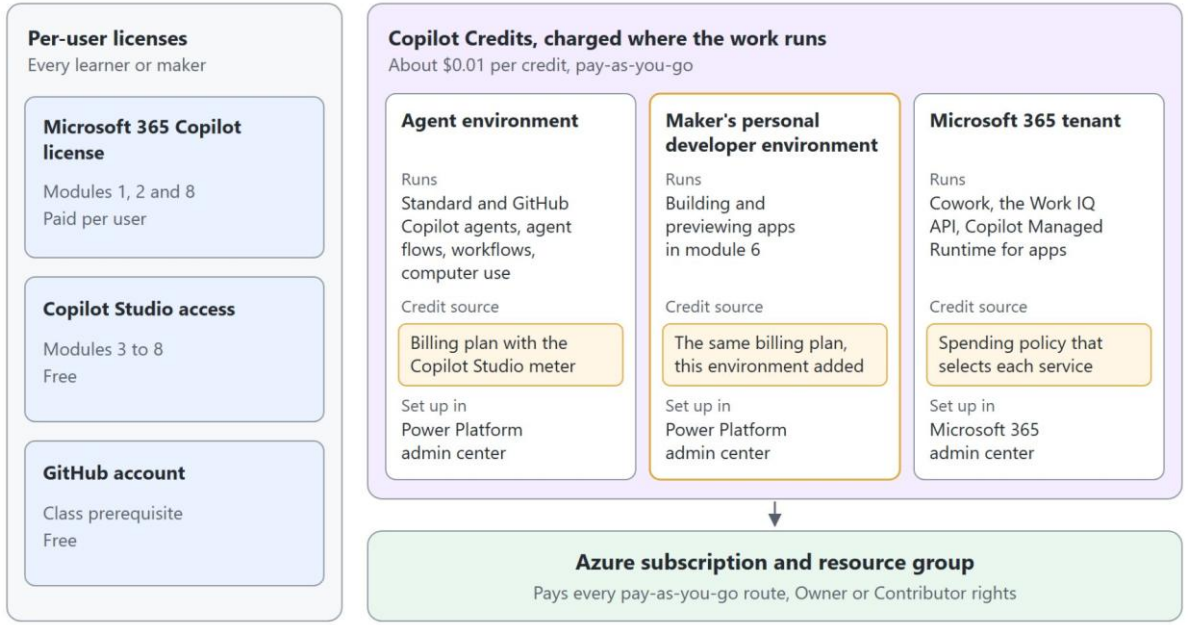
# Prepare the Tenant: Licenses & Credits

Optional: the licenses, credit sources and costs behind each module

# Licenses and credit sources

## Few seats, and credits charged where the work runs

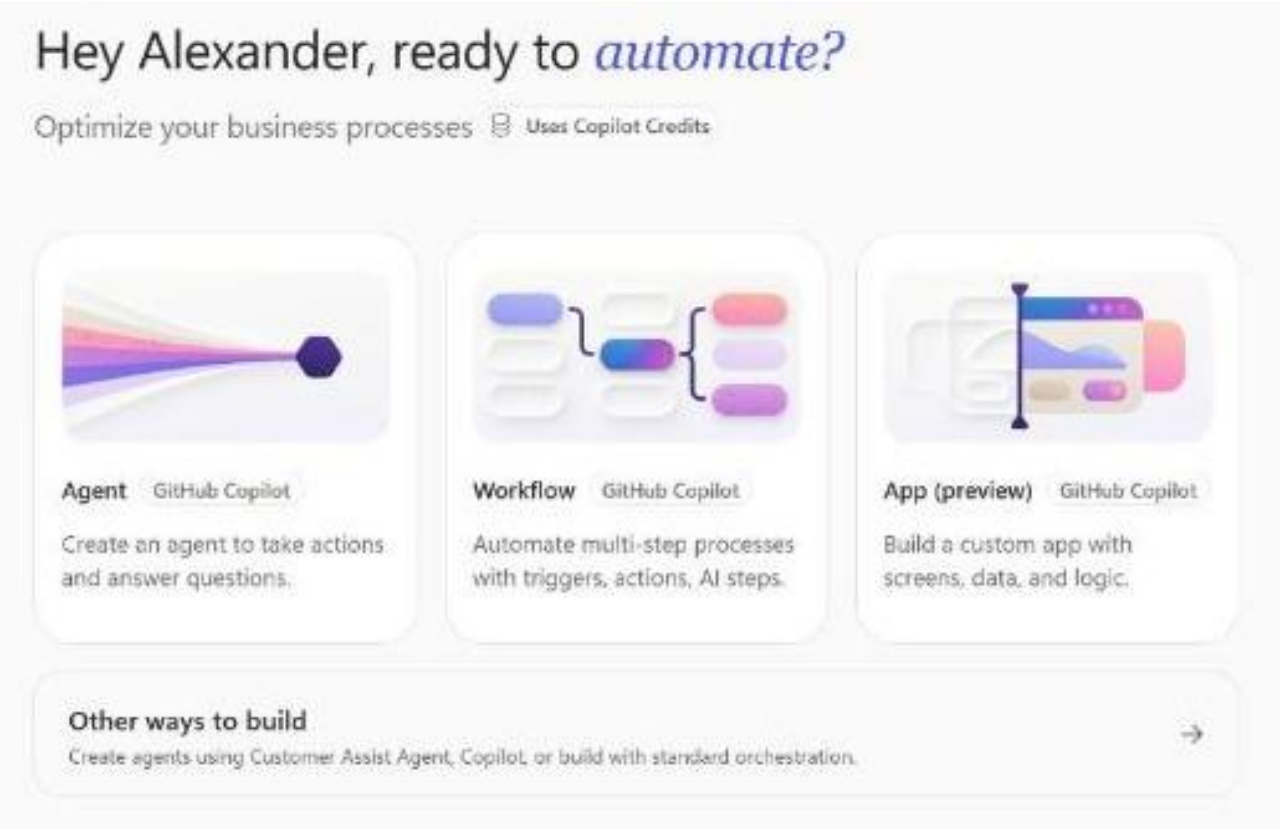
- **Per user**: a Microsoft 365 Copilot license, Copilot Studio access and a GitHub account
- Everything else is **Copilot Credits** or an Azure resource on one subscription
- Credits are charged **where the work runs**: agent environment, developer environment or tenant
- Each maker's **personal developer environment** needs the billing plan too



# What a Copilot license covers

## The harness decides whether building draws credits

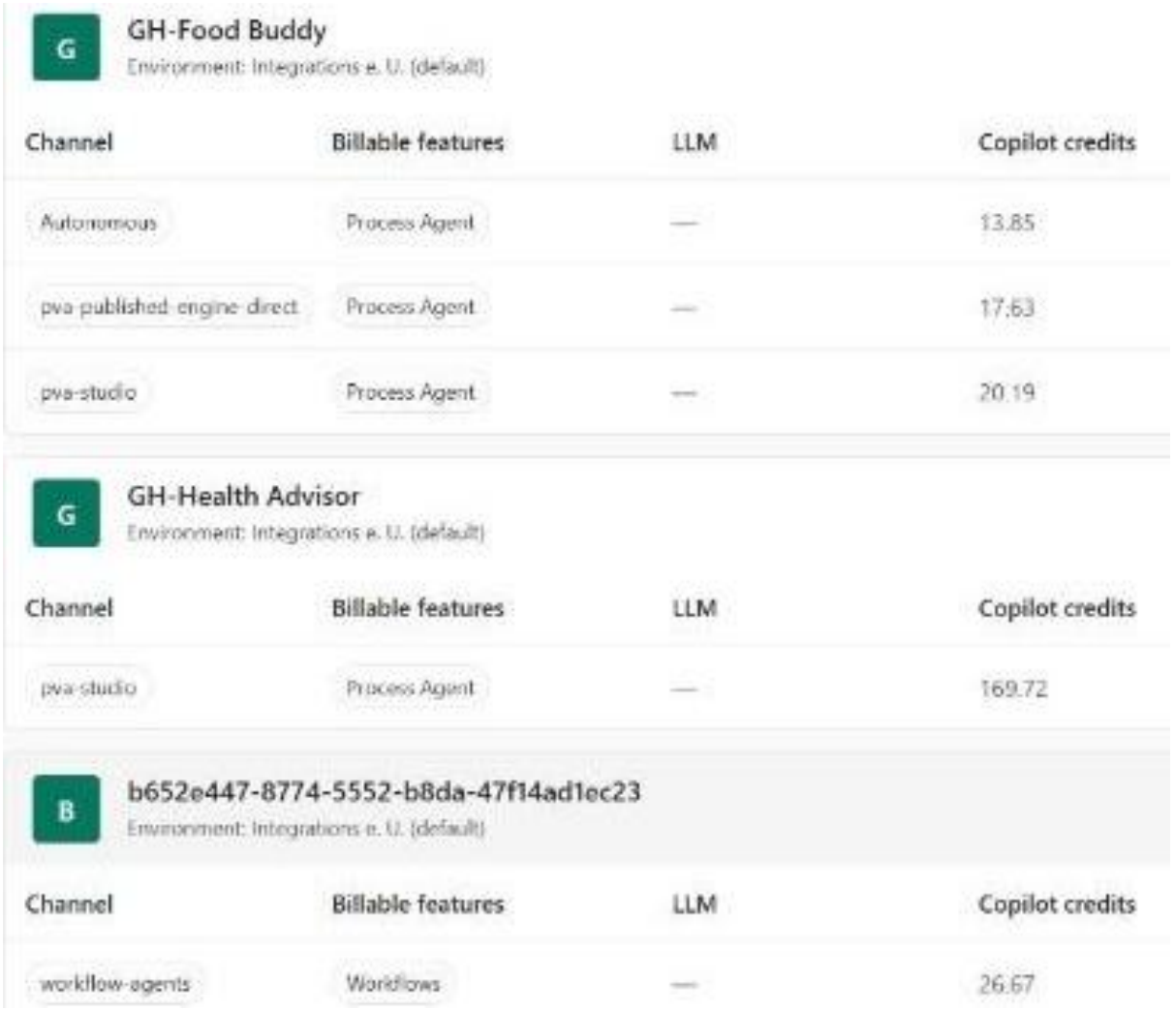
- **Standard agents** run zero-rated for licensed users in Microsoft 365 channels
- Their test chat costs nothing: every Standard agent demo ran at **0 credits**
- **GitHub Copilot agents**, workflows and apps bill from the first build step
- The Copilot Studio home page marks the paths that use **Copilot Credits**



# Where a run's cost shows

## Billed credits per agent in the Power Platform admin center

- **Manage Agents** lists billed credits per agent, channel and feature
- A GitHub Copilot agent: **169.72 credits** for five Preview sessions
- One workflow run: **26.67 credits** on the workflow-agents channel
- Work IQ API and Cowork costs show only in Microsoft 365 **Cost management**



# Takeaways

## What to carry into the Cowork module

- Every agent is a copilot with a **narrower job and more autonomy**
- An agent works toward a **goal** in a loop, and a person approves consequential actions
- Fix a weak agent by naming its thin part: **instructions, knowledge or tools**
- Choose the **harness** before you create the agent: it fixes behavior, features and billing
- Take the **lowest-effort path** that meets the need, and set **Copilot Credit** limits before the first bill

